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VIT BHOPAL

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Tab 1

Task 1

Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the creation of the digital literacy awareness slide, I utilized Canva, a versatile graphic design tool. I chose this platform because it allows for clean, professional work .

My design follows a structured three-strip horizontal layout. Each strip is dedicated to a specific pillar of digital literacy: What is digital literacy , Useful digital tools for students and safe internet practices. This layout was chosen specifically to improve readability, by breaking the information into three distinct visual zones.

One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was the challenge of visual hierarchy. I had to decide which template design and font type would grab a student's attention first.The aim was to make students aware. This project taught me that effective digital literacy isn't just about having the right information—it’s about designing it in a way that people actually stop to read.

Task 2

Task 2

Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

To build a robust professional identity, I have selected LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle as my primary digital platforms. LinkedIn serves as my professional introduction used for networking with industry experts, following tech leaders, and showcasing my academic milestones. GitHub is my repository where I do my actual code, such as my Python scripts and physics simulations, serving as a portfolio of my technical abilities. Kaggle is my chosen platform for data science and machine learning, offering a space to participate in competitions and practice data analysis using real-world datasets.

LinkedIn is used for building a professional brand,networking with colleagues,seniors and industry experts and finding internships which may land for a job offer.
GitHub: It is used for storing , managing and tracking changes to your code. It is where your actual work shows up.
Kaggle: This platform is for practicing data analysis, participating in coding competition and accessing public dataset

Over the next four years, my plan is to use these platforms in a synchronized manner. I will use GitHub daily to document my progress in core subjects like Data Structures and Algorithms. I will then share some of these projects on LinkedIn to build visibility within the tech community. By my third year, I intend to be more active on Kaggle, applying my Python skills to solve complex data challenges. Ultimately, this approach will ensure that by the time I reach my final year placements, I have a verified, public record of my growth, projects, and professional network.

Task 3

Task 3

Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For task 3, I focused on the two platforms HackerRank and Google Forms. On HackerRank, I engaged with the Python (Introduction) track, successfully solving foundational challenges that tested my understanding of basic syntax, loops, and conditional logic. Then , I used Google Forms to design a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" targeting my batchmates, incorporating various question types like multiple choice and short answers to assess and improve their knowledge.

These tools will be instrumental to my academic journey as a Computer Science student. Mastering HackerRank early on prepares me for the technical coding rounds and "Competitive Programming" environment that are essential for future internships and placements. It forces me to write efficient, error free code under specific constraints. Meanwhile, Google Forms is a vital tool for academic data collection and research. Whether I am gathering user requirements for a software project or conducting a survey or knowing how to structure digital queries professionally is a core skill. Together, these platforms bridge the gap between technical "hard skills" and the essential "soft skills" of communication and digital awareness.

Task 4

Task 4

Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A very common example of poor digital communication occurs during Phishing Scams targeting university students. In a common scenario, a student receives an urgent email that looks like an official university notification, claiming their student portal password has expired. Panicked by the professional-looking logo and the deadline, the student clicks a link and enters their credentials into a fake website. Or a potential internship offer that looks like the real but actually a fake one.

The real-world problem here is a breach of personal and academic data, potentially leading to financial loss or identity theft. The student should have checked the sender's actual email address instead of just the display name and hovered over the link to see the real URL. Most importantly, following the rule of never clicking login links from emails and instead navigating directly to the official university website would have prevented the crisis entirely.

Task 5

Task 5

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

The thing that surprised me most while researching UPI and online payment fraud was the psychological sophistication of social engineering over technical hacking. I initially assumed that cybercriminals needed advanced coding skills to break into bank accounts. However, I discovered that most frauds succeed simply by exploiting a user's lack of digital literacy, specifically the misconception that a UPI PIN is required to receive money. The realization that scammers create a false sense of urgency or panic to bypass a person's common sense was eye-opening.

As a result, the one habit I will personally change is my immediate response to urgent digital requests. Whether it is a refund notification or a deal that seems too good to be true, I will now practice a mandatory one-minute pause. During this time, I will verify the sender's identity and remember the golden rule: "No PIN for Credits." By slowing down my digital interactions, I can protect my money from impulsive mistakes.

conclusion

Conclusion

This project has been a comprehensive journey into the essential pillars of digital literacy and professional identity. By completing these tasks from designing an awareness quiz in Google Forms to solving Python challenges on HackerRank I have tried to bridge the gap between theoretical knowledge and practical application.

Through the case study on UPI and Online Payment Fraud, I realized that technical security is only one side, the other half is human awareness. My research into social engineering surprised me by showing how easily a lack of digital knowledge can lead to financial loss. As a result, I have committed to more careful and cautious online habits, ensuring that I verify every urgent request before acting.

By establishing my presence on LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle, I have laid the foundation for my career over the next four years at VIT Bhopal. These platforms will serve as a record of my growth as a programmer and a professional. Ultimately, this project has taught me that being digitally literate is not a one-time achievement, but a continuous process of staying informed, practicing safe habits, and building a transparent, professional digital footprint.